



Compensation Philosophy

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We want every edukian to understand the logic behind how they are paid, not just the number. Transparency is not about publishing every salary, but about making our reasoning legible. This page explains the principles that guide every compensation decision we make.

A note on Tech freelancers

Most of our Tech team work as freelancers. Their compensation consists of a fixed fee only. VSOP does not apply. All other principles on this page apply equally: fairness, market-anchoring, transparency, and proactive adjustments. Leveling follows the [Tech Leveling Framework](#).

Our principles

▼ Principle 1: Fair over equal

We pay based on role, level, and location, not on negotiation skill or personal circumstances. Fairness means consistent criteria applied consistently.

▼ Principle 2: Market-anchored, locally adjusted

Salaries are benchmarked against local market data. Cost of labour and cost of living vary significantly by country. A single global rate would be unfair in both directions.

▼ Principle 3: No performance bonuses

We do not offer variable bonuses. We believe in intrinsic motivation, and in a fast-moving company, bonus targets become outdated before they are earned. We compete on base salary and VSOP instead.

▼ Principle 4: Shared upside through equity

Every permanent employee participates in the value we build together through Virtual Stock Options (VSOP). This aligns incentives company-wide without creating individual competition.

▼ Principle 5: Proactive, not reactive

We do not wait for employees to ask for raises. Salary bands are reviewed annually against market data, and adjustments are applied automatically when market rates increase.

▼ Principle 6: Salaries never go down

If market rates drop, we do not lower existing salaries. Bands may adjust for future hires, but existing edukians are never affected negatively.

What we pay

Our monetary compensation package has two components that together make up **Total Compensation (TC)**:

-  **Fixed salary:** determined by role, seniority level, and home country, set within defined salary bands.
-  **VSOP:** Virtual Stock Options. Every permanent employee participates in eduki's long-term value.

┆  **Fix + VSOP = Total Compensation (TC)**

We intentionally do not offer performance bonuses. We believe bonuses introduce extrinsic motivation, create power dynamics in teams, and are incompatible with a fast-moving strategy environment where goals evolve throughout the year.